Risk policy and risk assessment.

Risk management in groundwork

VERSION	APPROVED	OWNER	WEB
1.0	27 October 2026	Managing director	pblondal.is/en/policies/ahaettustefna-og-ahaettumat/

Risk management means identifying hazards before they cause an accident, damage, extra cost or delay. For P. Blöndal ehf. it is especially important to identify hazards from trenches, unknown pipes and cables, driving, machine movements, lifting, soil, pollution, weather and coordination between contractors. The policy describes the method the company uses; a separate risk assessment is carried out for each site.

Method and decisions

First the task is defined: where the work takes place, with which machines, who is on site and who may be affected. Then we review what can go wrong, how serious the consequences could be and how likely an incident is in the actual conditions. Controls are chosen in order of priority: eliminate the hazard if possible, change the method, install technical safeguards, organise the work and finally use personal protective equipment as an additional measure. Hazards that cannot be reduced to an acceptable level mean the work is postponed.

Typical risks

Unconfirmed pipe and cable locations can lead to electrical accidents, burns from hot water or damage. A trench in loose soil can collapse on people, and a machine can reverse into a pedestrian if separation is inadequate. Incorrect transport or unstable site preparation can cause a machine to tip over or cause damage. Oil leaks can harm the soil and the sewer system. For each job, we identify which hazards apply and ensure the person in charge has the authority to stop work.

Job-specific assessment

A general policy is not enough when new conditions arise. Before digging, drawings, weather, ground conditions, the work area, traffic and emergency routes are confirmed. Coordination with others is assessed, as well as whether special permits or approvals are needed. The risk assessment is repeated when new pipes or cables are found, a trench gets deeper, a machine is replaced, traffic changes or conditions become unstable.

Records and responsibility

The person in charge of the job ensures that the results of the risk assessment and the controls are known to those doing the work. If an incident occurs, controls are reviewed and corrections confirmed. A written health and safety plan is prepared based on the actual conditions and the requirements in force. Risks related to data and information handling, delivery and operations are also assessed according to the size of the company.

Responsibility and review

The managing director is responsible for this document and for making sure its content is presented to everyone working on the company's behalf. It is reviewed when there are significant changes to the work, equipment or rules, after incidents, and otherwise regularly in line with the scale of the business.